
Bible Symbols

& Their Scriptural Meaning

*A Comprehensive A–Z Reference Chart of Biblical Symbols,
Their God-Intended Meaning, and Supporting Scripture*

*"To the law and to the testimony! If they do not speak according to this word,
it is because there is no light in them." — Isaiah 8:20*

"...comparing spiritual things with spiritual." — 1 Corinthians 2:13

This chart presents biblical symbols as interpreted by the Bible itself. Each symbol's meaning is established solely from Scripture — God's Word explains God's symbols. Symbols are arranged alphabetically. All references are drawn from the Old and New Testaments.

SYMBOL	MEANING	SCRIPTURAL REFERENCES
A		
Angel	Messenger / ministering spirit sent by God	Daniel 8:16; 9:21; Luke 1:19, 26; Hebrews 1:14
Ark of Testimony	Ark of the covenant / mercy seat where God dwells	Exodus 25:10-22; Psalm 80:1
Armor / Breastplate	Righteousness and spiritual protection	Isaiah 59:17; Ephesians 6:14-17; 1 Thessalonians 5:8
B		
Babylon	Religious apostasy, confusion, and spiritual harlotry	Genesis 10:8-10; 11:6-9; Revelation 17:1-5; 18:2-3
Balaam, Doctrine of	Advancing selfish interests, compromise, and idolatry	Numbers 22:5-25; 2 Peter 2:15; Revelation 2:14
Beast	Kingdom, government, or political power	Daniel 7:17, 23; Revelation 13:1-2
Bear	Destructive power; Medo-Persia prophetically	Proverbs 28:15; 2 Kings 2:23-24; Daniel 7:5
Binding of Satan	A symbolic chain of limiting circumstances	Isaiah 14:12-20; Revelation 20:1-3; 2 Peter 2:4
Black	Moral darkness, sin, and apostasy	Exodus 10:21-23; Jeremiah 4:20-28; 8:21; Joel 2:1-10; John 12:35
Blood	Life itself; atonement	Leviticus 17:11; Deuteronomy 12:23; Hebrews 9:22
Blue	The law of God	Numbers 15:38-39; Exodus 28:31
Book of Life	God's record of the redeemed	Exodus 32:32-33; Psalm 69:28; Revelation 3:5; 20:12
Bottomless Pit	Earth in chaos — dark, void, and empty	Genesis 1:1-2; Jeremiah 4:23-28; Isaiah 24:1-4, 19; Revelation 20:1-3
Bow	Victory in battle; success against evil	Psalm 7:11-12; 45:4-5; Zechariah 9:13-14
Bread	The Word of God; Christ Himself	John 6:35, 51, 52, 63; Matthew 4:4; Deuteronomy 8:3
Brass / Tin / Iron / Lead / Silver dross	Impure, corrupt character	Ezekiel 22:20-21; Isaiah 1:22
C		
Cedar Tree	Strength, majesty, and pride of nations	Ezekiel 31:3-9; Isaiah 2:13; Amos 2:9
Cloud	Divine presence and glory	Exodus 13:21-22; 40:34-38; Matthew 17:5; Revelation 1:7
Clothing / Garments	Character; covering of righteousness	Isaiah 64:6; 59:6; 61:10; Genesis 35:2; Zechariah 3:3-5; Romans 13:14

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Corrupt Woman	Corrupt, apostate church	Ezekiel 16:15-58; 23:2-21; Hosea 2:5; 3:1; Revelation 14:4
Crowns	Kingship, authority, and victory	1 Chronicles 20:2; 2 Kings 11:12; Ezekiel 21:26-27; James 1:12; 2 Timothy 4:7-8
Cup	Suffering, judgment, or portion given by God	Psalm 11:6; Isaiah 51:12, 22-23; Jeremiah 25:12-17; 49:12; Matthew 26:39
D		
Day	A literal year in prophetic reckoning	Ezekiel 4:6; Numbers 14:34
Dew	Spiritual refreshing; blessing from God	Hosea 14:5; Psalm 133:3; Proverbs 19:12
Door	Opportunity; time of probation and access to God	2 Corinthians 2:12; Revelation 3:7-8, 20; John 10:7-9
Dove	The Holy Spirit; peace	Genesis 8:11; Matthew 3:16; Mark 1:10; John 1:32
Dragon	Satan or his earthly agency	Isaiah 27:1; Psalm 74:13-14; Revelation 12:7, 9; 20:2; Ezekiel 29:3
Dross	Worthless impurity; unrefined character	Psalm 119:119; Proverbs 25:4; Isaiah 1:22; Ezekiel 22:18-19
E		
Eagle	Speed, power, vision, divine protection	Deuteronomy 28:49; Habakkuk 1:6-8; Revelation 12:14; Isaiah 40:31
Earthquake	Political or social upheaval; divine judgment	Isaiah 29:6; Haggai 2:6-7; Revelation 6:12; 11:19; Matthew 27:51-54
Eating of the Book	Fully assimilating God's message	Ezekiel 3:1-3; Jeremiah 15:16; Revelation 10:9-10
Egypt	Symbol of atheism; rejection of God's authority	Exodus 5:2; Isaiah 30:2-3; Revelation 11:8
Eyes	Spiritual discernment and understanding	Matthew 13:10-17; 1 John 2:11; Proverbs 20:12; Revelation 3:18
Eye Salve	Holy Spirit granting spiritual sight and discernment	Ephesians 1:12-19; Psalm 119:18; 1 John 2:20, 27; John 16:7-13
F		
Faithful Witness	Christ, who testifies of truth	John 18:37; 3:11; Revelation 1:5; 3:14; 19:11
False Prophet	Apostate Protestantism that supports the Beast	Revelation 16:13-14; 13:13-14; 19:20
Famine	Dearth of the Word of truth	Amos 8:11; Isaiah 55:1-3
Feet	One's walk, direction, and manner of life	Genesis 19:2; Psalm 119:105; Proverbs 4:26-27
Field	The world	Matthew 13:38; John 4:35

SYMBOL	MEANING	SCRIPTURAL REFERENCES
Fig Tree	A nation or people that ought to bear spiritual fruit	Luke 13:6-9 ; Matthew 21:19-20 ; Jeremiah 8:13
Fire	The Holy Spirit; also judgment and refinement	Luke 3:16 ; Isaiah 33:14 ; Malachi 3:2-3 ; Hebrews 12:29
Flood	Multitudes of people used as instruments of persecution	Isaiah 59:19 ; Revelation 12:15-16 ; Daniel 11:10
Forehead	The mind; seat of thought and allegiance	Romans 7:25 ; Ezekiel 3:8-9 ; Revelation 13:16 ; 14:9 ; Deuteronomy 6:8
Fornication (Spiritual)	Illicit union between the church and the world / state	Ezekiel 16:15, 26 ; Isaiah 23:17 ; James 4:4 ; Revelation 14:4 ; 17:2
Four Beasts / Living Creatures	Heavenly beings with special responsibilities before God	Revelation 5:8-10 ; 4:6-9 ; 6:1-7 ; 14:3 ; 15:7 ; 19:4
Four Corners of the Earth	The four compass directions; all the earth	Jeremiah 49:36 ; Isaiah 11:12 ; Revelation 7:1
Fruit	Works and actions produced by one's life	Galatians 5:22-23 ; Matthew 7:16-20 ; John 15:4-5
G		
Goat	Greece prophetically; also the wicked	Daniel 8:21 ; Matthew 25:32-33
Gold	True heavenly riches; faith refined; God's Word	Psalm 19:7-10 ; Job 23:10 ; Isaiah 13:12 ; Revelation 3:18
Gold (Impure)	Corrupt spiritual treasure / Babylon's false wealth	Revelation 17:4 ; 18:16 ; Isaiah 1:22
H		
Hand	Works, deeds, and actions	Ecclesiastes 9:10 ; Isaiah 59:6 ; Revelation 13:16
Harlot	Apostate church / religion that has forsaken God	Isaiah 1:21-27 ; Jeremiah 3:1-3, 6-9 ; Revelation 17:1-5
Harvest	The end of the world; final gathering of souls	Matthew 13:39 ; Revelation 14:14-16 ; Joel 3:13
Heads	Major ruling powers or governments	Revelation 17:3, 9-10 ; Daniel 7:6 ; 8:8, 22
Healing	Salvation and restoration of the soul	Luke 5:23-24 ; Isaiah 53:5 ; Matthew 9:5-6
Heart	The inner life; will, emotions, and moral centre	Proverbs 4:23 ; Jeremiah 17:9-10 ; Matthew 15:19 ; Ezekiel 36:26
Hidden Manna	Christ, the Bread of Life from heaven	John 6:49-50, 53 ; Matthew 13:44 ; Revelation 2:17
Honey	A happy, blessed, and prosperous life	Ezekiel 20:6 ; Deuteronomy 8:8-9 ; Psalm 19:10 ; 119:103

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Horn	King, kingdom, or seat of power and strength	Daniel 7:24 ; 8:5 , 21-22 ; Zechariah 1:18-19 ; Revelation 17:12
Horse	Strength and power in battle; swift divine agents	Job 39:19 ; Psalm 147:10 ; Proverbs 21:31 ; Zechariah 1:8-10 ; 6:1-8
I		
Image	A likeness; something fashioned to resemble another	Exodus 20:4 ; Genesis 1:26 ; 5:3 ; Daniel 2:31-33 ; Revelation 13:14-15
Incense	The prayers of God's people ascending before Him	Psalm 141:2 ; Revelation 5:8 ; 8:3-4 ; Exodus 30:7-8
Israel (True)	All genuine followers of Christ by faith	Romans 9:6-8 ; 2:28-29 ; Galatians 3:29 ; John 1:47
J		
Jar / Vessel	A person as a container of the Spirit	Jeremiah 18:1-4 ; 2 Corinthians 4:7 ; 2 Timothy 2:20-21
Jezebel	Immorality, idolatry, and apostasy within the church	1 Kings 21:25 ; 2 Kings 9:22 ; Revelation 2:20
Jordan	Death and transition; baptism into Christ	Romans 6:4 ; Deuteronomy 4:22 ; Joshua 3:13-17
K		
Key / Key of David	Authority; power to open and close the sanctuary	Revelation 3:7-8 ; Isaiah 22:22 ; Matthew 16:19
Keys	Control, jurisdiction, and authority	Isaiah 22:22 ; Matthew 16:19 ; Luke 11:52
L		
Lamb	Jesus Christ; the perfect sacrifice for sin	John 1:29 ; 1 Corinthians 5:7 ; Genesis 22:7-8 ; Revelation 5:6
Lamp / Candlestick	The Word of God; the Church bearing the light	Psalm 119:105 ; Revelation 1:20 ; Matthew 5:14-16
Lamb's Wife	The New Jerusalem; the redeemed church glorified	Revelation 19:7-9 ; 21:2 , 9-10 ; Ephesians 5:25-27
Leprosy / Sickness	The defilement of sin	Luke 5:23-24 ; Isaiah 1:5-6 ; Matthew 8:2-3
Leopard	Greece prophetically	Daniel 7:6 ; Habakkuk 1:8
Lion	Jesus as the King of kings; also Babylon as a devouring power	Revelation 5:4-9 ; Jeremiah 50:43-44 ; Daniel 7:4 , 17 , 23 ; 1 Peter 5:8
Locusts	Devastating armies bringing destruction	Joel 1:4 ; 2:25 ; Deuteronomy 28:38 ; Revelation 9:3-10
Lord's Day	The seventh-day Sabbath, the holy day of God	Isaiah 58:13 ; Matthew 12:8 ; Exodus 20:10 ; Revelation 1:10
M		

SYMBOL	MEANING	SCRIPTURAL REFERENCES
Man Child	Jesus Christ; also the overcoming church birthed in tribulation	Psalm 2:7-9; Revelation 12:5; Isaiah 66:7-8
Mark / Seal	A sign of ownership; approval or disapproval stamped on a person	Romans 4:11; Ezekiel 9:4; Revelation 13:17; 14:9-11; 7:2-3
Measuring Rod	God's law; His Word as the standard of judgment	James 2:10-12; Ecclesiastes 12:13-14; Isaiah 8:19-20; 2 Timothy 3:16-17
Merchants of Babylon	Advocates and promoters of Babylon's false teachings	Isaiah 47:11-15; Nahum 3:16; Revelation 18:3, 11, 15, 23
Moon	The Mosaic system of sacrifices and types; permanence of God's covenant	Psalm 89:35-37; Hebrews 10:1, 11; Colossians 2:16-17
Morning Star	Jesus Christ; the light that dispels all darkness	Revelation 22:16; 2:28; 2 Peter 1:19; Numbers 24:17
Mountains	Political or religio-political powers and kingdoms	Isaiah 2:2-3; Jeremiah 17:3; 31:23; 51:24-25; Daniel 2:35, 44-45
Mystery of God	The gospel of salvation revealed through Christ	Ephesians 1:9-10; 3:9; 6:19; Colossians 1:26-27; Romans 16:25-26
N		
New Jerusalem	The holy city of heaven; the eternal home of the redeemed	Revelation 3:12; 21:2, 10-27; Galatians 4:26; Hebrews 12:22
Night	A time of spiritual darkness, apostasy, or tribulation	John 9:4; Romans 13:12; 1 Thessalonians 5:5; Isaiah 60:2
Numbers (Symbolic):		
Three	The Godhead; completeness in witness or testing	Matthew 28:19; 1 John 5:7-8; Jonah 1:17; Matthew 12:40
Four	Universality; the four corners of the earth	Revelation 7:1; Isaiah 11:12; Jeremiah 49:36; Ezekiel 37:9
Six	Incompleteness; the number of man falling short of God	Revelation 13:18; 1 Chronicles 20:6; Daniel 3:1
Seven	Completeness and perfection; God's fullness	Genesis 2:2-3; Revelation 1:4, 12, 20; Leviticus 4:6
Ten	Completeness of human order; fullness of God's law	Exodus 20:3-17; Daniel 7:7; Revelation 17:12
Twelve	God's organized people; completeness of His church	Genesis 49:28; Matthew 10:1; Revelation 12:1; 21:12, 14
Forty	A period of testing and probation	Deuteronomy 8:2; Mark 1:13; Numbers 14:33-34; Ezekiel 4:6

SYMBOL	MEANING	SCRIPTURAL REFERENCES
Forty-Two months / 1260 days / Time, Times, Half a Time	1260 literal years of papal dominion (538–1798 AD)	Daniel 7:25 ; 12:7 ; Revelation 11:2-3 ; 12:6 , 14 ; 13:5
O		
Oak Tree	Strength; pride of the wicked that God cuts down	Isaiah 2:13 ; Amos 2:9 ; Ezekiel 31:14
Oil	The Holy Spirit; anointing and readiness	Zechariah 4:2-6 ; Revelation 4:5 ; Matthew 25:3-8 ; 1 John 2:20 , 27
Open Door	Unlimited opportunity; access granted by Christ	1 Corinthians 16:9 ; Acts 14:27 ; John 10:7-9 ; Revelation 3:7-8
P		
Pit	The grave; death; also the abyss of chaos	Isaiah 14:15 , 19 ; 38:17-18 ; Psalm 30:3 ; Revelation 9:1-2
Purple	Royalty and wealth	Mark 15:17 ; Judges 8:26 ; Revelation 17:4 ; 18:12
R		
Rainbow	Token of God's covenant and mercy	Genesis 9:11-17 ; Revelation 4:3 ; 10:1 ; Ezekiel 1:28
Ram	Medo-Persia prophetically	Daniel 8:20
Red / Scarlet	Sin and moral corruption	Isaiah 1:18 ; Nahum 2:3 ; Revelation 17:1-4 ; Genesis 38:28
Reapers	Angels who gather at the end of the world	Matthew 13:39 , 41 ; Revelation 14:15-19 ; Joel 3:13
Reins	The seat of will and deep affections	Psalm 7:9 ; 16:7 ; 26:2 ; 73:21 ; Proverbs 23:16 ; Jeremiah 17:10
Ring	Authority and delegated power	Genesis 41:42-43 ; Esther 3:10-11 ; Luke 15:22
River	Multitudes of people; also the Holy Spirit flowing from God	Revelation 17:15 ; Isaiah 8:7-8 ; John 7:38-39 ; Psalm 46:4
Rock	Christ; the unmovable truth of God	1 Corinthians 10:4 ; Isaiah 8:13-14 ; Romans 9:33 ; Matthew 7:24-25 ; Psalm 18:2
Rod / Staff	God's Word used for correction or comfort; authority	Psalm 23:4 ; Micah 7:14 ; Revelation 11:1 ; 2:27
S		
Sand	Innumerable multitudes	Genesis 22:17 ; Revelation 20:8 ; Hebrews 11:12
Seal	A mark of ownership, approval, or authentication	Romans 4:11 ; Revelation 7:2-3 ; Ephesians 1:13 ; 4:30 ; 2 Timothy 2:19
Second Death	The lake of fire; the final, permanent death of the wicked	Revelation 21:8 ; 20:6 , 14 ; 2:11

SYMBOL	MEANING	SCRIPTURAL REFERENCES
Seed	Descendants; ultimately Jesus Christ and His people	Romans 9:8; Galatians 3:16; Genesis 3:15; Matthew 13:38
Serpent / Snake	Satan; the old deceiver	Genesis 3:1, 14-15; Revelation 12:9; 20:2; 2 Corinthians 11:3
Seven Candlesticks	The seven churches of Asia; the whole church of God	Exodus 25:31-40; Revelation 1:20; Matthew 5:14
Seven Heads	Seven successive world-ruling powers	Revelation 17:9-10; Isaiah 2:2-4; Daniel 7:6; 8:8, 22
Seven Lamps of Fire	The seven Spirits of God; the fullness of the Holy Spirit	Zechariah 4:2; Revelation 4:5; 1:4; Isaiah 11:2
Sickle	The instrument of harvest; the end of the world	Matthew 13:39; Revelation 14:14-19; Joel 3:13
Silver	The pure words and understanding of God	Proverbs 2:4; 3:13-14; 10:20; 25:11; Psalm 12:6; 119:72
Skin (Pure animal)	Christ's righteousness covering the sinner	Exodus 12:5; 1 Peter 1:19; Isaiah 1:4-6; Genesis 3:21
Sodom	Moral degradation and vile wickedness	Ezekiel 16:46-55; Jeremiah 23:14; Genesis 19:4-14; Revelation 11:8
Stars	Angels or messengers of God's churches	Revelation 1:16, 20; 12:4, 7-9; Job 38:7; Daniel 12:3
Stone (White)	Acquittal and a new name given by Christ	Revelation 2:17; Isaiah 62:2; John 10:3
Sun	Jesus Christ; the gospel light	Psalm 84:11; Malachi 4:2; Matthew 17:2; John 8:12; 9:5
Sword	The Word of God; also literal bloodshed	Ephesians 6:17; Hebrews 4:12; Isaiah 3:25; 13:15; Jeremiah 48:2
T		
Testimony of Jesus	The spirit of prophecy; the Holy Spirit's gift of prophecy	Revelation 19:10; 22:9; 1 Corinthians 1:6; 12:10
Thief (Coming as a)	The unexpected manner of Christ's return for the unprepared	1 Thessalonians 5:2-4; 2 Peter 3:10; Matthew 24:43-44
Thorns / Thorny Ground	The cares and distractions of this life that choke spiritual growth	Mark 4:18-19; Genesis 3:17-18; Matthew 13:22
Time	360 days, representing 360 literal years in prophecy	Daniel 4:16, 23, 25, 32; 7:25; Daniel 11:13 margin
Times (Two)	720 days, representing 720 literal years in prophecy	Daniel 7:25; Revelation 12:6, 14; 13:5; 11:1-2
Tongue / Language	A people's speech, language, and identity	Exodus 4:10; Acts 2:3-4; Revelation 7:9; 13:7; 14:6

SYMBOL	MEANING	SCRIPTURAL REFERENCES
Tree	People or nations; the cross	Deuteronomy 21:22-23 ; Psalm 92:12 ; 37:35 ; Daniel 4:20-22 ; Ezekiel 17:24
Torment (by fire)	Testing and proving by trial	1 Corinthians 3:13 ; Hebrews 12:29 ; Isaiah 33:14
Trumpet	A loud, solemn warning of God's approach or judgment	Exodus 19:16-17 ; Joshua 6:4-5 ; 1 Corinthians 15:52 ; Revelation 8:7
Twenty-Four Elders	Representatives of the redeemed from earth surrounding God's throne	Revelation 5:9-10 ; 4:4 ; 7:9-14
Two-Edged Sword	The Word of God that judges and divides	Ephesians 6:17 ; Hebrews 4:12 ; Matthew 10:34 ; Revelation 1:16
Two Witnesses	The Old and New Testaments of Scripture	John 5:39 ; Zechariah 4:1-14 ; Psalm 119:130, 105 ; John 12:48 ; Revelation 11:3-4
V		
Vineyard	The church called to bear fruit for God	Luke 20:9-16 ; Isaiah 5:1-7 ; Matthew 21:33-43 ; John 15:1-5
Vials / Bowls	The seven last plagues of God's final judgment	Revelation 15:7 ; 16:1-21 ; Psalm 69:24
Voice of Many Waters	The voice of a great multitude; also Christ's majestic voice	Revelation 1:15 ; 17:15 ; 14:2 ; Psalm 93:4 ; Ezekiel 43:2
W		
Waters	Peoples, nations, multitudes, and tongues	Revelation 17:15 ; Isaiah 8:7 ; Psalm 144:7
Water	The Holy Spirit; also the Word of God cleansing and giving life	John 7:38-39 ; 4:14 ; Revelation 22:17 ; Ephesians 5:26
White	Purity and righteousness	Revelation 7:14 ; 19:8 ; Daniel 11:35 ; Isaiah 1:18
White Robes	The righteousness of Christ given to the victorious	Revelation 19:8 ; 3:5, 18 ; 7:14 ; Isaiah 61:10
Wilderness	A place of testing, trial, and divine provision	Deuteronomy 8:2-3 ; Hosea 2:14 ; Revelation 12:6, 14 ; Matthew 4:1
Winds	Strife, war, and political commotions	Jeremiah 25:31-33 ; 49:36-37 ; 4:11-13 ; Zechariah 7:14 ; Daniel 7:2
Wings	Speed, divine protection, and deliverance	Deuteronomy 28:49 ; Matthew 23:37 ; Revelation 12:14 ; Exodus 19:4 ; Isaiah 40:31
Wine (of Babylon)	False doctrines and traditions that intoxicate and corrupt	Luke 5:37 ; Isaiah 5:1-7 ; Revelation 17:2 ; 18:3 ; Jeremiah 51:7
Wolf	Disguised enemies who hunt and devour the flock	Matthew 7:15 ; John 10:12 ; Acts 20:29 ; Ezekiel 22:27

SYMBOL	MEANING	SCRIPTURAL REFERENCES
Woman (Pure)	The true, faithful church of God	Jeremiah 6:2 ; 2 Corinthians 11:2 ; Ephesians 5:23-27 ; Revelation 12:1
Woman (Corrupt)	An apostate church that has forsaken God	Ezekiel 16:15-58 ; 23:2-21 ; Hosea 2:5 ; 3:1 ; Revelation 17:1-5
Wormwood	Bitter sorrow, poison, and the fruit of forsaking God	Jeremiah 9:15 ; 23:15 ; Lamentations 3:19 ; Revelation 8:11
Wrath of God	The seven last plagues poured out at the end	Revelation 15:1 ; 16:1-21 ; Isaiah 13:9 ; Zephaniah 1:15
Y		
Yoke	Servitude, burden, or the easy yoke of Christ	Matthew 11:29-30 ; Isaiah 58:6 ; Jeremiah 27:8 ; Galatians 5:1

Note on Numbers: Symbols marked with sub-entries under 'Numbers (Symbolic)' are numeric patterns found consistently throughout both Testaments. These are interpreted by comparing their usage across Scripture, consistent with 1 Corinthians 2:13 and Isaiah 28:9-10.